Embedded Finance Build Day

August 25 2026. A House, Slussen
kl 08 - 20

Danske Bank Froda Open Payments
WORLDLINE zwapgrid

Registration Closes August 21.

Embedded Finance aims to make financial access seamless into our daily habits.

Here is your inspiration packet to jump start your **building experience.**

To all the

Problem Solvers: the problems mentioned here are **costing real businesses** a lot of money.

This packet exists so teams don’t spend the first two hours of Build Day staring at a blank Figma file. You are not required to use any of these problems or ideas. You are 100% welcome to arrive with your own ideas and build those instead.

Your team owns the idea, not the organizers. Think of your team as potential co-founders to a solution companies have been waiting for.

We are here to support innovation and to support you. Welcome to the first **Nordic industry-wide** finance hackathon.

Practical Info

01
CONNECT WITH YOUR TEAM

If you are registered for the event:
Embedded Finance Build Day · Luma

Then you will be assigned a team. After you have been assigned:

- [ ] Check your email for your team banner
- [ ] Post the banner & tag your teammates on Linkedin
- [ ] Connect on Linkedin and start a Group (Whatsapp or Linkedin)

02
START YOUR TEAM COMMUNICATIONS

Now that you know your co-founders, start the ideas flowing.

- [ ] Schedule a 30 minute meet & greet before the event
- [ ] Write about ideas in the Group
- [ ] Get inspired about Problems to solve

03
EXPLORE THE TECHNOLOGIES

Before arriving on August 25th, explore the technologies on your own.

Create an account in both Open Payments and Zwapgrid and try connecting to the APIs. What did you understand? What questions did you have? They will be on site on the day of the event to help you with any questions you might have.

04
ITEMS TO BRING TO THE EVENT

- [ ] Your laptop
- [ ] Lunch (We will have lunch options available for purchase)
- [ ] An idea of what you'd like to build with your team
- [ ] Chosen your technology you will build with: Open Payments and / or Zwapgrid

*Breakfast & Dinner are included. But if you have any special allergies please email: alexandra@alexandrastudio.se

05
SEE YOU AUGUST 25TH

Check-in opens at 8. We have a breakfast mingle from 8-9.

From 9.30-16 you will build with your team.

Submissions are due kl 16 on August 25th. We will send you the links where you can upload your submissions by August 21st.

Unglamorous Yet Real Problems

for Nordic Companies and their Finances

Introduction

Problems in Data Fragmentation

What is Open Banking?

Open Banking (PSD2) is a law that requires traditional banks to open secure access to customer payment account data for licensed third-party providers via dedicated APIs, provided the account holder gives explicit, informed consent.

PSD2 (Open Banking) mandated access. **It did not mandate standardisation.**

McKinsey Global Institute has put the unrealised value of open financial data at roughly 1 to 1.5 percent of GDP by 2030 across the EU, UK and US.

According to Finansinspektionen, Problems with Open Banking are happening in specific places where the data arrives but it arrives incomplete, inconsistent, or not at all.

For example a Bank can returns the account holder name on roughly 81 percent of personal accounts, meaning about one account in five comes back nameless. ING in the Netherlands returns a creditor account on 36 percent of personal debit transactions.

There are around 4,491 financial institutions across Europe, a large share of them exposing open banking APIs, each with its own implementation, authentication flow and data shape. No party has both the obligation and the incentive to fix this. The bank has met its regulatory duty by exposing the interface. Under PSD2 it cannot charge for access,

Who cares?

A Swedish company banking across two or three institutions cannot get a reliable consolidated view of its own money from the regulated interfaces alone. FI listed better access to credit and advisory services for small and medium companies as one of the clearest opportunities of open financial services. That opportunity is currently blocked on plumbing.

Brainstorming:

- When the bank does not return a holder name, say so, rather than presenting a blank as a fact.
- Enrichment by triangulation.
- A well-built map of what is actually missing, per bank, per account type, is a real contribution.
- A demo that catches an inverted sign or a duplicated service-fee identifier before it

so investment in field completeness for business accounts competes against every revenue-generating project in the bank and loses. FI's own respondents raised exactly this: several data holders argued that without a mechanism for economic incentives, interface quality risks landing below what the market needs.

reaches a ledger is small, unglamorous, and immediately useful.

Without clean, verified data, Banks and Lending institutions are slower and less knowledgable about their customer, requiring higher fees to provide lending, money movement and services.

Problem 2.

Problems in Authentication

In April 2022 the EBA finalised amended technical standards that introduced a mandatory SCA exemption for access via an account information provider and extended the renewal interval from 90 days to 180 days.

Under PSD2, strong customer authentication is required when a customer accesses their payment account online, whether directly or through an account information provider. That authentication has to be renewed on a clock.

The consequence is that every product built on continuous account data has a scheduled failure built into it. On renewal day the customer must go back to their bank and authenticate again, and a meaningful share of them simply do not. Reported drop-off at renewal has run above 50 percent in some businesses. A user study by one UK provider put it in the 20 to 40 percent range, and projected 5 to 15 percent once the friction was removed.

FIDA, the regulation to fix this- that would extend access beyond payment accounts into savings, pensions, insurance and loans, was still in trilogue in spring 2026, with realistic operation around 2029 or 2030.

This problem affects all consent based financial data across the EU.

Brainstorming:

- Renewal as a designed moment rather than an error state.
- Graceful degradation. When the feed stops, what does the product still do?
- Prediction and staging. Renewals across a company's several bank connections drift out of sync and each one breaks separately. Cluster them, warn ahead, renew in one pass.
- Who re-authenticates when the account has three signatories and the person who set up the connection has left the company?

Problem 3.

Problems with Invoicing and Fraud

How common is financial Fraud?
In Sweden, Brå recorded 232,862 reported fraud offences during 2025. The Police estimate that organised crime, money laundering and fraud together cost Swedish society somewhere between 100 and 150 billion kronor a year.

A finance assistant at a mid-sized Swedish company receives an invoice from a supplier they have paid thirty times before. Same logo, same layout, same contact name, correct amount, correct reference. One field has changed: the bank account number, with a short line explaining the company has switched banks.

She pays it. She authenticates properly. Every security control in the chain works exactly as designed, and the money is gone.

Money taken in a fraud has to leave through an account. Usually a real account, belonging to a real person, often recruited or coerced into the role.

The same receivable is sold to more than one financier. When the debtor pays, one financier is made whole and the others are not.

TransCare in the United States collapsed into bankruptcy in 2016 after selling the same invoices to multiple lenders, and duplicate financing has been a recurring theme in the trade finance losses of the last several years.

Brainstorming:

- The invoice that does not exist
- The invoice financed twice
- Two financiers are looking at the same receivable
- What does manipulated bank or ERP data look like, and what would catch it?

Problem 4.

Problems in Sales / Marketing

Imagine if Sales teams understood their customers problems through financial data?

The data is available, in some cases openly published by the Swedish state, and the reason nobody has built this is that the people who understand financial data and the people who own commercial decisions work in different departments and have never been in the same room.

You are about to be in the same room.

Sales teams qualify prospects on headcount from a scrape, funding from a press release, and a job title that was true eighteen months ago. They are trying to answer commercial questions: is this company real, growing, solvent, worth the effort, about to churn, ready to buy more.

Financial data is unfashionable in go-to-market. It is seen as a finance function input, or a credit input, not a targeting input. The people who own the CRM do not think in terms of equity ratios and the people who read annual reports are not asked what sales should do.

An annual report tells you about a financial year that ended some months ago. The interesting builds combine filings with something live.

Brainstorming:

- A qualification score built from actual financials
- Trigger detection from filings
- Segment by financial behaviour rather than by industry.
- Build the tool that tells a rep not to call.
- A churn signal from payment behaviour.
- Any B2B company extending payment terms is a lender who has never thought of itself as one.
- Expansion timing.
- Cash-flow-aware pricing and terms.

Problem 5.

Problems with Financial Decisions

For the company with no CFO. There are around 820,000 limited companies in Sweden. The overwhelming majority of them have no finance function at all.

The person deciding whether to hire, whether to take an order that requires buying stock, whether to pay a supplier now or in three weeks, is the same person who does the selling and the delivering. Their financial picture arrives from an external accountant, some weeks after the period it describes, in a format designed to satisfy Skatteverket rather than to help anyone decide anything.

They are not confused because they are unsophisticated. They are confused because the information reaches them late, in the wrong shape, and priced as an accountant's hourly rate.

In 2025, 10,731 Swedish companies went bankrupt, affecting 24,882 employees. That was seven percent fewer than 2024, which had been the highest level since the crisis of the 1990s. Across the EU, roughly one in two commercial invoices is paid late or

An SME sends an invoice with thirty day terms. It is paid on day fifty-two. This happens repeatedly, and the owner absorbs it, because the customer is a good customer and nobody wants to start that conversation over a small amount.

Brainstorming:

- Predict who pays late.
- Decision support, not reporting. Can I afford this hire. Can I take this order.
- Smart invoicing and payment returns
- Make the entitlement visible.
- What does a reminder look like that a small supplier is willing to send to a large customer?
- A skattekonto explained in plain language. Not a balance. A sentence: you owe this, on this date, and if you miss it the cost is this much per day.
- The cash calendar.

not at all, and around one in four bankruptcies is attributed to unpaid invoices.

Sources

Additional Reading.

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Building the Future of Finance Together.

Welcome to the first
Nordic industry-wide
finance hackathon

Danske Bank

Froda

Open Payments

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zwapgrid